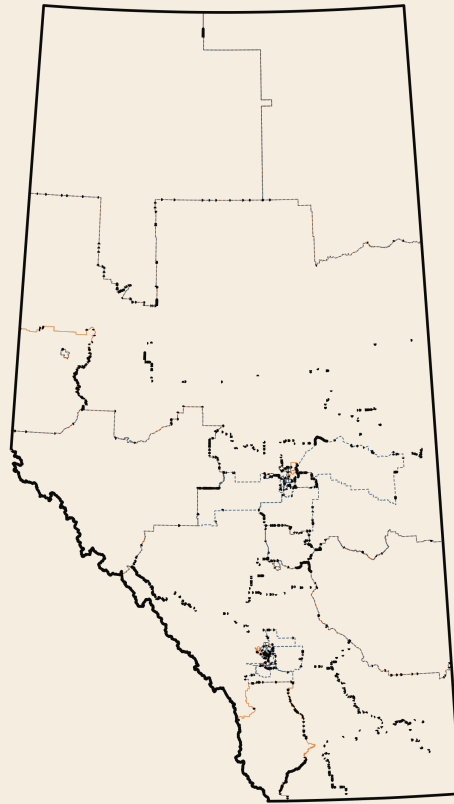


AN ELECTORAL BOUNDARIES AUDIT
ALBERTA · 2026



— 2019 BASELINE

— MAJORITY 2026

— MINORITY 2026

The *Quiet* Part.

Alberta's electoral-boundary commission split three to two. The government threw out both maps and handed the drafting pencil to five MLAs instead. An audit of what was rejected, what the government is promising, and what to watch for in November.

BY WILL CONNER

wconn161@mtroyal.ca

FULL TECHNICAL REPORT

willconner.ca/ab_ed/26_04_analysis

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BY WILL CONNER · WCONN161@MTROYAL.CA · PUBLISHED APRIL 23, 2026

[Full technical report](#) · [Repository and data](#)

On page 66 of a report nobody outside a handful of Alberta lawyers will ever read cover to cover, Justice Dallas Miller sat alone and wrote a sentence most chairs would never write. He was the head of Alberta's Electoral Boundaries Commission — a sitting judge, appointed by the Lieutenant Governor in Council, the tiebreaker whose job exists so that election maps get drawn by somebody other than the party in power. He had presided over a year of public hearings. He had signed the three-of-five majority report. And now, in an addendum to that same report, he was writing a fifth recommendation — a fallback, a what-if — and he had to explain, in the voice of the document itself, why his own majority colleagues had declined to sign it.

"My majority colleagues do not agree with me on this point," he wrote. "That is why I am alone in making this recommendation."

Nine days later, Premier Danielle Smith held up that page in the Alberta legislature. She cited that recommendation. She did not read that sentence. On April 16, the government she leads voted 44 to 36 to throw out both maps the commission produced — the majority's and the minority's — and hand the pencil to a committee of five MLAs. Three UCP. Two NDP. Seven months to finish. No public hearings required by the motion, and none scheduled.

From his seat across the aisle, NDP leader Naheed Nenshi stood and called it what he thought it was. "Let's be clear," he said. "Not adopting the commission's report is cheating, not adopting the commission's report is gerrymandering, and, in fact, not adopting the report is a full-on assault on our democracy."

Rachel Notley, who faced an unfavourable commission report herself as premier in 2017 and accepted it, wrote in a Globe op-ed a few days later that "at no time did I even casually consider abusing my power as Premier." Jared Wesley, the University of Alberta political scientist who chaired

Edmonton's 2019–2020 Ward Boundaries Commission, said any casual observer could see it for what it was. Commissioner Greg Clark, one of the two opposition-nominated members of the three who signed the majority map, posted one line: in Canada, we don't want elected officials drawing their own election maps.

So which is it? Is Alberta watching a gerrymander, an override, an engineered supermajority — or a legitimate process being dressed up to look worse than it is? The words flew fast in the week after the vote. The lines themselves — what the commission actually drew, what one map does to your ballot in 2027 that the other one doesn't — got less attention.

I spent two days pulling population tables, commission appendices, and Elections Alberta's 2023 vote file to answer a narrower question. Not who was right. Whether the numbers back the words.

What follows is that audit. Every fact traces to a public source. Three of the findings contradicted the direction I expected, and all three matter. The majority map's Canmore-Banff riding, which I had initially flagged as borderline on the Act's remote-district rule, turned out to qualify cleanly under the corrected thresholds. The minority's partisan-direction signal reversed under 2019 voters and flipped again under April 2026 polling, so the shape of Alberta's 2020s electorate is what makes the map UCP-favourable, not the lines themselves. And the chair's own claim that five minority configurations had "no public support" turned out to be materially wrong on three of them. A reproducible audit has to answer back. This one did, more than once.

Before the evidence, though, the arguments.

PART I • THE ARGUMENT

Three arguments are alive in Alberta right now, and they do not say the same thing.

The first belongs to Nenshi and to NDP MLA Rakhi Pancholi. Pancholi has called the minority commission map — the 89-seat proposal from the two UCP-appointed commissioners — a gerrymander, and the April 16 override "cheating." Her framing is about the map. The shape of the lines.

The second belongs to Notley and Wesley, and it is about process. A commission exists so legislators cannot draw their own districts. Quebec's government amended its commission in 1992. Ontario's did in 1996. BC's did in 2008. None of the three dissolved the commission mid-cycle and installed a legislative committee in its place. "An attempt to gerrymander Alberta's electoral map to the advantage of the governing party," Wesley called it. Notley's comparison to her own 2017 call — accept the commission, grit your teeth — is the governing template she wants Albertans to remember.

The third argument is the quietest, and the hardest to answer. Call it the supermajority claim. Notley wrote it first — in a *Globe and Mail* op-ed a few days after the vote, she called the UCP "cheating to secure themselves a supermajority." Nenshi picked up the word on the floor. National editorials picked it up from there. The question underneath it is whether Alberta is watching a map drawn to lock in a UCP floor through the 2031 and 2035 elections — and beyond those, until the next commission convenes.

Premier Smith disagrees with all three, and her defence rests on a single piece of paper. On April 16, she stood in Question Period and pointed at the very page this piece opened on. "I've been asking every member to look at page 66 of the report and the judge's addendum to the majority report," she said. She told members the addendum showed the majority of the commission itself recommending 91 seats — precisely what the government was doing.

Pressed five days later on whether a committee of five MLAs could really redraw 91 ridings in seven months, she told the opposition: "The members opposite should take our AI academy, because then they'd learn how to use the marvels of modern technology as well so that they can develop their own maps." It raised the question of how a committee would use such tools. Algorithmic map-drawing is real. How a committee uses it — which prompts, which seeds, which ensembles it picks from — is the difference between a defensible use of modern technology and a black box with a partisan output. The scorecard in Part III takes this up.

That is one way to read page 66. It is not the only way. Whether a map meets the letter of a rule and whether it meets the rule's purpose are two different questions, and the answer to the second is where this audit ends up.

Before we weigh the readings, a short detour through the vocabulary.

PART II • THE EVIDENCE

THE COMMISSION'S SPLIT

SIDEBAR — GERRYMANDERING 101

PACKING

— stuff opposition voters into a few districts where they win huge. Every vote above 50%+1 is wasted.

CRACKING

— spread them thin across many districts where they lose narrowly.

ENGINEERED LINES

— draw a shape that satisfies a legal rule without representing any real community.

All three leave measurable fingerprints in the vote data.

The five commissioners split three to two. Miller, Clark, and Susan Samson of Sylvan Lake signed the majority report. John D. Evans, KC, of Lethbridge and Dr. Julian Martin of Sherwood Park — both nominated by the UCP government — signed the minority. Each side submitted its own 89-seat map, adding two seats to the 2017 total to absorb Alberta's roughly twenty-percent population growth. On most of the province, the two maps agree. On about a dozen districts they do not, and on five of those the disagreement is sharp enough that the audit built its tests around them.

These five districts are the story — Rocky Mountain House-Banff Park, Olds-Three Hills-Didsbury, Calgary-Nolan Hill-Cochrane, Airdrie, and Chestermere. Each is a test case for one of the three gerrymander fingerprints, and each produces a real consequence for real people. I'll take them one at a time, in scenes, because numbers that don't live in anybody's kitchen stay abstract.

Scene one • The ballot that doesn't say Airdrie

It's a Monday in late June 2027. The woman is in her thirties, she has lived in Airdrie for eleven years, she works at a dental office on Main Street, and she is walking from her kitchen table to her front door with an advance-polling card in her hand. She knows how to vote. She has done this before. What is different this time is the card. Under the minority's map, her riding is not Airdrie. Her riding is Calgary-Foothills-Airdrie West, and the member her vote helps elect will also answer to the people of Calgary-Foothills.

She has three neighbours within two blocks. One lives in Calgary-Foothills-Airdrie West with her. One lives in Airdrie East, which also exists on this map. The third lives in Olds-Three Hills-Didsbury — three towns she has never shopped in — because the rural riding reaches up to capture a slice of north Airdrie to clear its lower population limit. That third neighbour votes for an MLA she shares with Didsbury and Three Hills, an hour north. Her own MLA will answer to Calgary-Foothills, fifteen kilometres south.

Three ridings, counting the ones that touch her front door. Airdrie East is the only one of the three that carries the city's name.

Airdrie is Alberta's sixth-largest city. Its 2025 municipal census put it at just over 90,000 residents. Under the majority map, it is split two ways, both named Airdrie. Under the minority map, it is split four ways, and none of the four is named Airdrie.

Does population force the four-way split? It does not. Airdrie fits into two roughly-equal districts well inside the Act's ± 25 -percent band. The minority's own defence — that Airdrie was too large to keep as two — does not survive the arithmetic. Nor do the population-math defences for Red Deer's four-way carve or for Chestermere's split into Calgary, once the Act's actual thresholds are applied.

I then ran the same check on every Alberta city over 50,000 residents. The majority splits none of them four ways; the minority splits three: Airdrie, Lethbridge, Red Deer. Three cities, one pattern.



Airdrie: one city, two partitions

Figure 1. A schematic of Airdrie's two partitions. Top bar: the majority's two Airdrie-named ridings. Bottom bar: the minority's three segments, only one of which carries the Airdrie name on its own. The carve at the right edge belongs to a rural district reaching north into Olds, Three Hills, and Didsbury.

Similar patterns appeared in Lethbridge and Red Deer under the minority's map — three Lethbridge-prefixed hybrids pulling rural territory from Cardston, Fort MacLeod-Crowsnest Pass, and Little Bow into districts named for the city, and four Red Deer-prefixed hybrids where the majority drew two. Schematics for both cities are in the [full technical report](#).

That is cracking; the formal signature is detected in one map only, and it shows up in three cities with the same fingerprint.

Move south now, to where the pattern changes shape — and where the wasted vote lives somewhere harder to see.

Scene two • The zone line

Two Calgarians live ten minutes apart by car. One lives in the northeast, near Falconridge, in an older NDP-leaning district; the other lives in the southwest, near Lake Bonavista, in a newer UCP-leaning one. They commute on the same ring road, shop at the same Costco at Deerfoot Meadows,

and sit on the same municipal voters' list.

Under the majority's map, their two districts hold roughly the same number of people — about 55,000 each, give or take half a percent. Under the minority's, they do not. The minority's NDP-leaning Calgary districts hold, on average, 61,225 residents. Its UCP-leaning ones hold 54,569. A 12.2-percent gap, drawn straight from the commission's own tables.

What that means in practice: the same number of NDP votes in Calgary elects fewer MLAs. Roughly 113,000 NDP-leaning voters are being carried by the larger districts, spread across seventeen of the city's ridings. Under a tied provincial vote, the minority map loses the NDP one to two Calgary seats the majority map would not.

That is packing. The formal signature is detected.

The majority map doesn't do this. Its Calgary zones sit within 0.4 percent of each other. Same city, same electorate, same day: one map sees a zone gap you could drive a truck through, and the other does not.

Leave the city now. Head west, then north, up into country where the line runs through rock — and where the question stops being *is this unequal* and becomes *is this even a community*.

Scene three · The line through empty country

Drive the Icefields Parkway north from Lake Louise on a Tuesday in late September and you will cross into what the minority commission's map calls Rocky Mountain House-Banff Park. You will also cross roughly forty kilometres in which there is nobody to represent. No house. No farm. No store. The district boundary sits in the middle of the road, which runs through alpine the Province of Alberta shares with federal Parks Canada. The district reaches that piece of road because the minority drew the boundary through it.

Why? The district qualifies as a remote riding under provincial law without the park extension — Clearwater County is remote, sparsely populated, and far from Edmonton regardless of where the western boundary falls. The park doesn't make the district legal. It just relocates the boundary from real communities to an empty road.

So why run the boundary through the park at all?

The minority had populated alternatives. Caroline. Nordegg. More of Mountain View County. Parts of Bighorn MD. The Sundre area. Each of them a real community with residents, an economy, a stake in who represents them. The minority's own paperwork says the commission considered this territory. Page 352 of the commission report offers four rationales for the configuration — highway-22 corridors, Rocky Mountain House as Clearwater hub, regional Indian reserves, and historical precedent. Three of those rationales are community-of-interest arguments that apply equally to the

no-park-extension alternative; the only rationale unique to the park route is the fourth, which reads verbatim: "the historical precedent of portions of Banff National Park being included in a west central Alberta electoral division."

A historical-precedent rationale does real work in some contexts; here it rests on a shape that adds no represented community. The boundary could have represented Caroline, Nordegg, or more of Mountain View County. It was drawn to represent the BC border.

The law requires remote districts to serve communities, not geography. The park extension adds no represented community. The boundary is engineered.

The majority map did not propose a Rocky Mountain House-Banff Park district at all. On Canmore-Banff, the majority's own remote-district invocation, the corrected thresholds make it a clean pass. The majority's Canmore-Banff is legitimate. The minority's Rocky Mountain House-Banff Park is legitimate on paper and engineered in its shape.

Two rural seats still favour the UCP on average, because rural Alberta has voted two-to-one UCP for decades. That rural-seat arithmetic is one of the two mechanisms carrying the small seat-count gap between the maps. The other — Calgary's zone gap — carries the rest.

Three scenes. Three signatures. One more piece of the minority's defence stands: the chair said the disputed configurations had no public support. That claim needs checking, because it is the reason the chair himself gave for rejecting them.

The support the chair missed

Miller's Appendix C argued that five minority configurations — Airdrie, Cochrane, Chestermere, Red Deer, and St. Albert — had no backing in the public record. The commission took roughly 1,345 written submissions across two rounds of hearings. I was able to keyword-search 1,252 of them. A more granular picture emerged.

Of the five configurations Miller named, three hold (Airdrie four-way, Nolan Hill-Cochrane, and St. Albert-Sturgeon genuinely had no public support), but two are material errors — Red Deer's record was evenly divided rather than absent, and Chestermere as its own unit had three submissions in favour and only one opposed. Meanwhile, two configurations the chair did not name — Rocky Mountain House-Banff Park and Olds-Three Hills-Didsbury — each attracted multiple submissions the minority adopted. The full seven-configuration breakdown is in the [technical report](#).

The minority's map carries pieces of the public record the chair said were absent, alongside choices he said were absent that really were. The chair was right about most of his "no support" list but overstated it, and the minority's most-contested configurations draw selectively from the record in both directions.

The audit's strongest single piece of contrary public evidence is submission EBC-2025-2-0619, a detailed position paper from a Nordegg resident proposing the Rocky Mountain House-Banff configuration the minority eventually adopted. It is ten pages long. It names specific boundary points. The chair wrote in Appendix C that no citizen had proposed this district. The paper exists.

The four standard tests

TEST	THE PLAIN-ENGLISH VERSION	2019	MAJORITY 2026	MINORITY 2026
Efficiency gap	Whose votes get wasted more — the losers' or the winners'?	-2.64%	-1.29%	-2.71%
Mean-median gap	Is one party's vote share spread evenly across districts, or clumped?	-2.22	-0.16	-0.34
NDP seats at a tied vote	If the whole province voted fifty-fifty, how many seats would the NDP win?	46	44	42
Declination	When you chart each party's winning margins, do the two parties' wins look alike or lopsided?	-0.034	-0.021	-0.015

Table 3. Reading convention: negative numbers favour the UCP; positive favour the NDP.

In plain terms: the minority map tilts the playing field toward the UCP, but not enough to change a landslide — only enough to matter in a close race.

Three of the four measures confirm this. The fourth points the other way, but it and the other three are measuring the same underlying thing from different angles — NDP voters concentrated into tight losses rather than big wins — so the apparent disagreement is the same signal read twice.

The effect is real but not large: one to three seats at a tied provincial vote, with the direction depending on which election cycle you use as a baseline. Under 2023 voting patterns the minority map favours the UCP; under April 2026 polling it favours the NDP; under 2019 it's close to zero. The lines have a lean. The electorate's own lean is bigger.

The audit can say this. The minority map is not an extreme gerrymander under any published international standard. It is also not neutral under the vote patterns of the most recent election. It sits in a middle register — measurable partisan asymmetry, small but directional, concentrated in Calgary.

A separate test generated a hundred thousand computer-drawn legal Alberta maps and asked where each real map sits in that distribution. Every map has some UCP tilt built in — NDP voters cluster in Edmonton and central Calgary, UCP voters spread across the suburbs and the rural, so even a

neutral draw produces more UCP seats on a tied vote. The question is where each real map sits against that floor. The majority map and the 2019 boundaries both land in the middle of the pack. The minority map lands near the top of the UCP-favourable tail on one measure and near the bottom on a second — the same mechanism viewed from two angles. The majority is unremarkable. The minority is an outlier.

The Calgary hybrids

Total hybrid-district counts are almost identical across the three maps. What changed is the location.

MAP	TOTAL HYBRID DISTRICTS	CALGARY HYBRIDS	EDMONTON HYBRIDS	REST-OF-PROVINCE
2019 (current)	19	0	0	19
Majority 2026	19	4	2	13
Minority 2026	20	7	4	9

Table 4. Hybrid-district count and distribution by region.

Each of the minority's seven Calgary hybrids folds a rural community or small town — Bearspaw, Springbank, Cochrane, Chestermere, Airdrie-West, Tsuut'ina Nation — into a district where a Calgary neighbourhood holds the majority of the population. The rural voice, in each case, becomes the secondary voice. The same pattern appears around Red Deer.

 Calgary: where rural territory enters the city

Figure 4. Calgary and three of the minority's Calgary-named hybrids. Calgary-Nolan Hill-Cochrane reaches northwest toward Cochrane. Calgary-De Winton reaches south into the rural corridor toward High River. Calgary-West-Tsuut'ina reaches west across the municipal boundary to include Tsuut'ina Nation territory. The majority map draws none of these three. Calgary-West-Tsuut'ina has no transcribed 2026 polygon yet and is shown here using the 2019 Calgary-West shape as a visual stand-in.

The Cochrane-into-Calgary hybrid is a useful test of the commission's own commute logic. The minority defends Calgary-Nolan Hill-Cochrane on the grounds that Cochrane is a Calgary commuter town, and some of it is. Statistics Canada's 2021 journey-to-work data shows 36 percent of Cochrane workers commute to Calgary, spread across a dozen destinations. Thirty-six percent is

real. It is not an overwhelming majority, and it does not by itself answer whether Cochrane residents should be drawn into a district called Calgary-Nolan Hill rather than a district named for Cochrane.

Premier Smith has said, paraphrasing what she reads as the commission's own concern, that it "made it clear it did not want to lose two rural ridings." If rural preservation is the policy goal, the majority map moves in that direction — its rural-seat count is higher than the minority's. The minority's seven Calgary hybrids and four Red Deer hybrids move the other way, pulling rural and small-town voters into districts dominated by urban neighbours. Whether either pattern matches the Premier's stated goal is a question the next map will answer.

Three patterns now, set against a single checklist.

The three signatures

The minority map shows all three. The majority map shows none.

Airdrie is cracked across four ridings so the city's votes are diluted in every one of them. Calgary's NDP-leaning ridings are packed larger than its UCP-leaning ones, so the same number of votes elects fewer MLAs. And Rocky Mountain House-Banff Park's western boundary runs through empty alpine when real communities were available — a line drawn for legal cover, not for representation.

Three signatures. All in the minority map. None in the majority's.

These signatures are not fully independent. Packing inside Calgary and cracking at Airdrie's northern edge hit the same voters from two directions: NDP-competitive Calgarians are packed into larger ridings where their votes pile up in seats they already win, while Airdrie's fragments are redistributed into ridings anchored in UCP-leaning suburban territory. NDP-competitive Calgary can't expand northward because its boundary has already been reassigned.

Red Deer and Lethbridge follow a simpler version of the same logic. Both cities need exactly two ridings to stay within the Act's population limits. The minority map draws four for Red Deer and three for Lethbridge, splitting each urban core and attaching every fragment to rural territory that has voted UCP at roughly two-to-one. There's no within-city packing — both cities are too small for that mechanism — but the outcome is the same: every seat gets a rural anchor, and in Alberta that anchor points one way. Whether Edmonton's outer ridings show a similar effect is a question Elections Alberta's unreleased shapefiles will answer.

The minority offered defences for each contested boundary. The population-math defences — Airdrie was too big for two ridings, Red Deer needed four, Chestermere couldn't stand alone — don't survive the census numbers. The shared-institution defences hold in one case (Red Deer Catholic Regional genuinely buses students between both cities) and fall short in the others. The full rationale review is in the [technical report](#).

Which leaves the Premier's strongest card. The one she held up in Question Period.

The 91-seat recommendation's author

Page 66, again. Miller's addendum.

The recommendation is written in the voice of "the majority of the Commission" and asks the legislature to amend the *Electoral Divisions Act* to raise the count from 89 to 91, restoring the two rural seats the majority report removed. Premier Smith cited this on April 16 as her warrant for what the government had done. What she did not read out is the sentence a paragraph later: "*My majority colleagues do not agree with me on this point.*"

The addendum also carried four conditions. No changes in Airdrie or south of it. No changes north of Edmonton's North Saskatchewan River. South-Edmonton ridings revert to the interim draft. A Clearwater/western Mountain View seat restored. Miller stated the addendum's purpose in plain words: "to dissuade the Legislature from accepting the minority report."

The April 16 motion borrowed the 91-seat number. It did not borrow the majority map as a starting point. It did not borrow the four conditions. It did not borrow the purpose.

On the commission's own paperwork, "the chair's recommendation" came from the chair alone, was conditional on the Legislature rejecting the majority map rather than embracing the minority one, and was explicitly written against what the April 16 committee is positioned to produce.

That is the reading of page 66 the government did not cite.

The April 16 override

A select committee chaired by UCP MLA Brandon Lundy has until November 2 to recommend a 91-seat map. An advisory panel sits behind the committee; its members and terms of reference had not been published as of late April. Elections Alberta called the timeline "very challenging." Boundary changes are meant to be in place at least eighteen months before a general election. Alberta's next is scheduled for fall 2027.

The commission's two maps are off the table. But everything the commission documented — the packing signatures in Calgary, the cracking of Airdrie and Red Deer, the engineered lines at the mountain boundary, the population thresholds — is now the measuring stick. The Lundy committee inherits not the maps but the test. What it produces on November 2 is the map Alberta will actually run three elections on, and the commission's work is exactly what tells us whether it passes.

PART III • THE LONG LOOK

On the night of May 29, 2023, a vote count in Calgary-Acadia came in five one-hundredths of a percentage point apart. The NDP won. Fourteen of the province's 87 ridings were decided by less than three points in 2023 — nearly double the seven from 2019. Twelve of those fourteen are in Calgary. Seven are in the NDP-leaning zone the minority's packing analysis flags.

Apply a 1.5-point swing toward the UCP to the 2023 results — the middle of the map-effect estimate — and six seats flip: five in Calgary plus Banff-Kananaskis. Apply the same swing the other way and four seats move toward the NDP.

The 2023 election was not close enough for a map effect this size to change which party formed government. UCP won 49 to NDP's 38 — an eleven-seat gap — and a one-to-three-seat shift is a rounding error at that spread. The 338Canada aggregator's April 2026 snapshot projects UCP 63 to NDP 24. By that measure, 2027 does not look close either.

Still. Alberta polling has moved more than ten points inside a single cycle, twice, in the last decade. A fourteen-point April spread is not locked in. And the adopted map is in place for more than one election — 2027, 2031, 2035, and beyond, until the next commission convenes.

Here is when the map matters. In a 2023-style blowout, it does not change who governs. In an election that lands within five seats of a tie, a one-to-three-seat effect is exactly the size that decides whether a party governs with a majority, a minority, or from the opposition benches.

Ask Diana Batten, the 2023 NDP winner in Calgary-Acadia, about five one-hundredths of a percentage point. Ask the UCP in Calgary-North West about 0.30. A 1.5-point shift from map design is not theoretical headroom. In those specific seats, it is the same size as the gap that decided the seat last time.

Which returns us to the three hypotheses.

On gerrymander, the minority map carries three formal signatures the majority does not. The partisan *direction* depends on the electorate — UCP-favourable under 2023, NDP-favourable under April 2026 polling, near-zero under 2019. The structural signatures are stable; the magnitude is small and contingent. It is not nothing. It is not extreme.

On the override, the April 16 step replaced the drafting process itself rather than simply its output. An ordinary legislative non-adoption stretched into something without provincial precedent. The "the commission asked for this" defence rests on an addendum the chair himself disavowed in the same document. This is the finding where the audit's confidence is highest.

On the supermajority claim, no tested electorate produces it. A one-to-three-seat shift cannot bridge an eleven-seat gap. Under April 2026 polling, the shift actually favours the NDP. What the audit does find is smaller and more specific: a structural thumb on the scale in tight elections. A 0.51 pp bias and a roughly one-seat shift are invisible in a landslide year and close to decisive in a knife-edge one. That is the scale of the map-effect the audit can measure.

Even casual observers can see it for what it is.

Wesley's phrase fits the process more neatly than it fits the map. The process is where the confidence is highest; the map is where the signals are measurable and small. The November draft is where the two stop being separable.

The checklist below was locked on April 22 — before the Lundy committee drew a single line — so the rubric cannot be reverse-engineered from a result that does not yet exist.

✂ FOLD HERE

SCORECARD — CLIP AND SAVE: NOVEMBER 2

Print this. Grade the Lundy committee's map when it drops.

SURE-SIGN BAR:

three or more red flags together would be very difficult to explain as anything other than deliberate partisan design.

SIGNAL	WHAT TO LOOK FOR	FLAG
Airdrie split	City carved into four or more separate ridings	Red
Calgary population gap	NDP-leaning ridings average 10%+ more residents than UCP-leaning ones	Red
Edmonton packing	NDP-heavy neighbourhoods folded into fewer, larger ridings	Red
Urban cracking	Mid-size cities split into more ridings than population warrants	Red
Boundary through nowhere	Rural riding border runs through empty wilderness when routes following towns existed	Red
Lopsided computer odds	Map lands in top 5% UCP-favourable of all legally drawn alternatives	Red
Public input reversed	Configurations the public asked for dropped; opposed ones kept	Red
Process closed	No hearings, no draft released, no dissent published	Yellow
Unexplained tools	AI used but prompts, settings, and candidate maps not released	Yellow
UCP wins more seats / NDP ridings flip	Could be voters shifting, not lines	Not a flag
Rural ridings smaller / odd shapes	Alberta's geography explains these	Not a flag

SCORES TODAY.

Majority map: zero flags. Minority map: three red, two yellow, plus contradicted rationales. Neither meets the sure-sign bar. November will be graded the same way.

YOUR TURN

The audit can tell you what the existing maps do. It cannot redraw the map the Lundy committee is about to produce. That is five MLAs — three UCP, two NDP — seven months, and a small number of decisions you can still influence.

Watch November 2. The committee tables its map that day. Part III above is your scorecard. If the committee preserves the Airdrie four-way split, the Calgary zone gap, and the Rocky Mountain House extension while adding new packing in Edmonton, the rubric says you are looking at the strong-signal version. If the committee keeps Rocky Mountain House and Olds-Three Hills-Didsbury intact, drops the Airdrie four-way, balances Calgary's zones, and publishes dissent alongside the map, the rubric says something else. You do not need the audit to tell you which is which. The scorecard is on the page.

Ask for a public-consultation window. The motion is silent on public hearings, and none have been scheduled. Pressure from constituents is what turns "silent" into "scheduled." If the committee does open a submission window, write a submission. Name your city. Name your streets. Commissions and committees read submissions that name actual places more carefully than submissions that recite slogans.

Know whether your MLA is on the committee. The Lundy committee's members are public. Three UCP, two NDP, as the opening set up. If one of them represents you, your email gets read. If not, your own MLA's office still tracks constituent mail, and mail from a constituent about boundaries is unusual enough that it registers.

Share the data, not just the op-eds. Every number in this piece traces to a public file anyone can run. Share the [repository](#). It is not a partisan document. It is a grader's pencil.

Remember in 2027 — and 2031, and 2035. The map the committee produces will shape not one but three election cycles. If the November 2 draft is clean on the rubric, vote the issues. If it isn't, vote with the rubric in mind. The ballot that arrives in your mailbox in 2027 will be the answer to questions being drafted right now.

THE LIMITS

A few points, to forestall each side reaching for the version of the finding that flatters them.

The minority map is not an extreme gerrymander. The majority map is not neutral — Alberta's geography gives any good-faith map a small UCP tilt. "More neutral than the minority" is fair. "Neutral" is not.

The April 16 override is not established as a constitutional violation. The Supreme Court's 1991 Saskatchewan Reference sets an "effective representation" standard with room for legislative involvement. Whether April 16 clears that bar is a question for courts.

The Lundy committee's map cannot yet be called anything, because it does not exist. Calling it a gerrymander today asks for a leap the data does not make. Calling it benign asks for the same leap.

THE METHOD

Every number in this piece can be re-run from public files. The [full technical report](#) walks every calculation, cites every submission, and lists every script. Running them on the same public data will produce the numbers that appear above. If you find an error, file an issue at the [repository](#).

One known limitation: Elections Alberta has not yet published the official 2026 boundary shapefiles. A formal request for those files has been filed and is awaiting response. In the meantime, synthetic boundary files were constructed from the commission's own report text and Appendix E descriptions, then refined by snapping to road, river, and administrative features from OpenStreetMap. Three refinement passes brought positional error on the district lines used in this analysis to within ± 1 km. The analysis that depends on precise line placement — compactness scores and some vote-attribution estimates for hybrid districts — remains the part most likely to shift when the official files arrive. The population equality findings and the partisan-bias metrics do not depend on shapefiles and are unaffected by this gap.

THE AUTHOR

Will Conner has previously supported the Alberta New Democratic Party. He has not worked for the Electoral Boundaries Commission or acted as a consultant for either side, past or present. He is a fourth-year Computer Information Systems student at Mount Royal University.

FURTHER READING

- [Full technical report with every calculation cited](#)

- [Marginal-seats analysis and 2023 flip-zone list](#)
 - [Rationale-by-rationale validation of the minority report's justifications](#)
 - [Chair's Recommendation 5 addendum, close reading](#)
 - [Terms of Reference audit, including threshold corrections](#)
 - [Section 15\(2\) re-audit under corrected thresholds](#)
 - [Source repository, data, and commit history](#)
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THE SOURCE TRAIL

Sources and submission identifiers are cited in-line throughout. Full bibliography in the [technical report](#). Key public sources:

- Chair Miller's Recommendation 5 addendum, including the text "*My majority colleagues do not agree with me on this point*": Electoral Boundaries Commission Final Report, Addendum to Majority Report, pp. 66–67
 - CBC News Edmonton, April 16, 2026: [MLA committee to review Alberta electoral boundaries after report is set aside](#)
 - Premier Smith's April 17 legislature statement and April 16 Rimbey Review quote
 - Commissioner Greg Clark's post on X, April 2026, referenced at [rabble.ca](#) and [albertapolitics.substack.com](#)
 - Statistics Canada, 2021 Census of Population and Journey-to-Work tables
 - Elections Alberta 2023 Statement of Vote
 - Electoral Boundaries Commission Act, RSA 2000 c. E-3, King's Printer consolidation, December 5, 2024
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Will Conner can be reached at wconn161@mtroyal.ca. This audit was produced with open-source tooling and public data; the reproducible pipeline, including every script and dataset, is at github.com/Ixby/alberta-electoral-boundaries-audit.
